SERIES BIBLE · SEQUEL HANDOFF

MAFIA WARS

DADOU VS EVEN

THE SPIRIT OF THE FIRST GAME

Everything a new Claude needs to know to build the sequel without losing what made the original Dadou's and Even's game.





VS



DADOU

EVEN

CHAPTER 0

Read me first, Claude

Hello. You are being handed this document because the person you are talking to wants a **sequel** to **MAFIA WARS : Dadou vs Even**, a game that another Claude built with them. You do not have that conversation, so this document is the memory of it: what the game was, how it looked and felt, how it was built, what went wrong, and which rules must survive into the sequel. The screenshots are real captures of the finished game.

The original was asked for in one long, very precise prompt. The user cared a lot about **names, French language quality, atmosphere and polish**, and about an **honest report** of what works and what does not. Expect the same standard.

The non-negotiables: keep these unless the user explicitly says otherwise

1. **It is a personal rivalry between two real friends.** The two godfathers are named exactly **Dadou** and **Even**. Never "David", never "Evan", never a nickname. Their gangs are *« La Mafia de Dadou »* and *« La Mafia d'Even »* (note the elision *d'*).
2. **Every player-facing word is in natural, correct French**: menus, HUD, notifications, newspaper, tutorial, errors. That includes contractions and elisions (*du, des, au, aux, d', l'*). The original had a small grammar helper (`src/shared/french.ts`) so that generated sentences never said "de Le Chat Noir".
3. **Two humans, online, symmetrical.** Lobby: *« Choisissez votre parrain »*, buttons *« Jouer Dadou »* / *« Jouer Even »*. A godfather taken by one player is unavailable to the other. Ready buttons, room codes, invite link, reconnection.
4. **You are the boss in person.** The player walks, runs and shoots in the street in first or third person (key V), and is also the strategist at his desk. Orders given on the map are executed *physically* by visible men walking through the city, not by dice rolls off screen.
5. **The office desk is sacred.** Each HQ has a furnished office; walking to the desk shows *« Bureau de Dadou »* / *« Bureau d'Even »* and opens the strategic map.
6. **Voxel, but warm and polished.** Not a grey prototype: gaslight, fog, bloom, colour, furnished interiors you can enter, Victorian typography, a newspaper, mission cards, a real victory screen (*« DADOU RÈGNE SUR LONDRES ! »*) and a *« Revanche »* button.
7. **Each boss keeps his identity**: Dadou = crimson and black, flamboyant. Even = navy and silver, elegant (see chapter 2).
8. **Honest reporting.** Test for real, say what was tested, list known limitations. The first game ended with a transparent "known limitations" section in its README; do the same.

What the sequel is free to change (ask the user first)

The era, the city, the scale, the camera, new mechanics, new modes (co-op, AI opponent, more players), the tech stack. The first game was London 1888. A sequel could stay there or move (for example to 1920s Chicago or Paris). That is the user's decision, not yours: propose, then let them choose. Chapter 9 lists ideas.

How this document is organised

1	The pitch: what the game was	6	The look, the sound, the words
2	The two godfathers	7	Under the hood (technology)
3	The city: London 1888	8	Lessons learned and honest limitations
4	How a match plays	9	Ideas for the sequel
5	Systems and numbers	10	A starter prompt you can adapt

CHAPTER 1

The pitch

« Londres, 1888. Deux parrains se disputent la capitale : Dadou, le flamboyant maître de Soho, et Even, l'élégant seigneur des Docks. »

(opening line of the in-game manual)

MAFIA WARS : Dadou vs Even is a 3D voxel game for exactly two players over the internet or a local network. Each player is a Victorian crime boss. You start in your own pub (the HQ) with a little money, five men and one lieutenant, and you must take over London one building at a time, district by district, until your rival's headquarters falls.

It mixes two games in one: a **third/first-person action game** (you are physically in the street with your revolver, your men follow you, you push through doors, fight in pubs) and a **real-time strategy game** (from your desk, you recruit, hire lieutenants, buy upgrades and send squads across the city). The best players do both: they lead the decisive assault personally while their lieutenants hold the rest of the map.



Main menu. Night skyline of London, Big Ben, gas lamps, moon. The logo: London skyline, « MAFIA WARS », a « DADOU VS EVEN » ribbon and two crossed revolvers.



Lobby: « Choisissez votre parrain ». Room code (top right), players list, match settings, chat. Each card shows the boss, his HQ and a « Jouer » button.

What a session looks like

1. The host double-clicks `MafiaWars.exe` (or runs the Node server). The browser opens on the menu.
2. He clicks *« Créer une partie »*, gets a 4-letter room code and an invite link, and sends it to the friend.
3. Both pick a godfather, adjust settings (time limit, day/night cycle, intro mission), press *« Prêt »*.
4. The city is generated on each machine (a few seconds) and both players spawn in their office, in front of the desk.
5. The first mission card appears: *« PREMIÈRE MISSION — PRENEZ LE CONTRÔLE »*.
6. A match lasts until a headquarters is captured or the time limit ends. Then the victory screen, statistics, and *« Revanche »* for an immediate rematch with the same players.



Spawn in Dadou's office, third-person view. The first mission card explains the goal in French: take Le Chat Noir with Arthur Collins.



Victory: « EVEN RÈGNE SUR LONDRES ! », the front page of the Gazette, a statistics table for both mafias, then « Revanche ».

CHAPTER 2

The two godfathers

The whole game is built around these two characters. They are real people (the user and a friend), so they must be recognisable, flattering and fun. Their colours run through everything: the voxel models, the emblems, the HUD, the flags on captured buildings, the map, the victory screen.



DADOU

« Le flamboyant parrain de Soho. Manteau noir, melon et moustache en guidon. »

Gang	La Mafia de Dadou
Look	Black overcoat, bowler hat with red band, crimson waistcoat and cravat, handlebar moustache, revolver.
Colours	Crimson `#9e1b22` · black · gold
Emblem	Golden "D" under a crown, laurels, « LA MAFIA DE DADOU · LONDRES · 1888 »
HQ	**Le Lion Rouge**, a pub in **Soho** (north-west corner)
Lieutenants	Arthur Collins (starts with him), Thomas Blake, Henry Walsh, Edward Miller, Frederick Hale, Walter Briggs
1st mission	Take **Le Chat Noir**, a gambling den nearby.



EVEN

« L'élégant parrain des Docks. Redingote bleu marine, haut-de-forme et monocle. »

Gang	La Mafia d'Even
Look	Navy frock coat with silver buttons, top hat, monocle, grey beard, revolver.
Colours	Navy `#1d3461` · silver · white
Emblem	Silver "E" on an anchor, navy waves, « LA MAFIA D'EVEN · LONDRES · 1888 »
HQ	**L'Ancre Bleue**, a pub in **the Docks** (south-east corner, on the Thames)
Lieutenants	William Hayes (starts with him), George Turner, Charles Reed, James Fletcher, Albert Crane, Samuel Pike
1st mission	Take **l'Entrepôt Morgan**, a warehouse nearby.

Balance rule. The two sides are mechanically identical: same money, same men, same prices, mirrored positions on the map (Soho in one corner, the Docks in the opposite one). Their difference is purely aesthetic and personal. Keep it that way unless the user asks for asymmetric factions.

CHAPTER 3

The city: London, 1888

A compact, hand-designed London of about 200 × 160 metres, generated in voxels (0.5 m blocks) from a plan in `src/shared/city/plan.ts`. Six districts in a 3 × 2 grid, each with its own architecture, its own neutral gang defending it, and around five named buildings. **Every building can be entered and is furnished** (bars, tables, beds, safes, machines, shelves...). Streets have cobblestones, pavements, gas lamps, posters, shop signs, barrels, carts, horse-drawn cabs and passers-by.

District	Neutral gang	Mood	Some buildings
Soho	Les Chats de Soho	Pubs, gambling dens, music-halls: the festive heart	Le Lion Rouge (Dadou HQ), Le Chat Noir, Music-hall Alhambra, Café Royal, Le Valet de Pique
La City	Les Gants Blancs	Banks and offices: the Empire's money	Banque Royale de Londres, La Bourse, Café Lloyd's, Compagnie des Indes, Hôtel des Postes
Whitechapel	Les Rats de Whitechapel	Miserable alleys, lodging houses, pawnbrokers	Les Dix Cloches, Prêteur sur gages Cohen, Christ Church, Taudis de Dorset Street
Westminster	Le Cercle de Pembroke	Mansions, clubs, the clock tower	Scotland Yard, Manoir Pembroke, Club Reform, Tour de l'Horloge
Quartier industriel	Les Cogneurs de la Fonderie	Foundries, breweries, smoking chimneys	Fonderie Hawthorne, Brasserie Royale, Filature Lancaster, Usine à gaz
Les Docks	Le Gang du Quai	Warehouses, smuggling, ships on the Thames	L'Ancre Bleue (Even HQ), Entrepôt Morgan, Douanes de Sa Majesté, Chantier naval



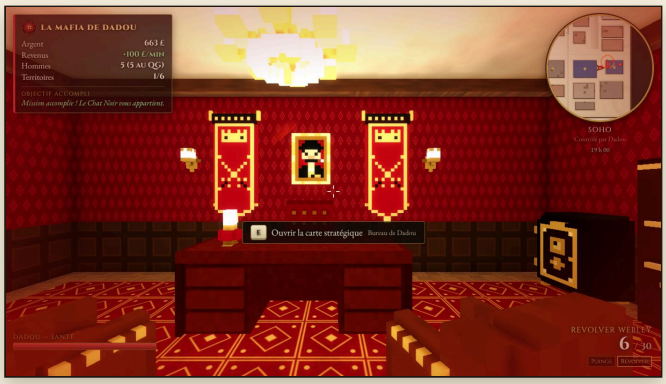
Daytime near the Docks: Even in third person, brick warehouses, gas lamps, cobbles.



Whitechapel at night: narrow alley, few lamps, darkness as a gameplay element.



The quays at dusk, near Even's HQ. Moored boats and crates on the Thames.



Inside Even's office at dusk: chandelier, banners, bookshelves, carpet, desk. Interiors were a big part of the charm.

Time of day is a match setting: full day/night cycle, permanent night, or permanent dusk. Night changes the mood (lit windows, lamps, bloom) and visibility.

CHAPTER 4

How a match plays

Each boss starts in his office with **£500**, **5 gangsters** and **1 lieutenant**. Everything else is neutral and defended by local thugs. The core loop:

Earn	Recruit	Organise	Order	Capture
Owned buildings pay £/min. Districts add a bonus.	At the HQ bar or desk: 1, 5 or 10 men.	Hire lieutenants and give them squads.	Desk map or Q wheel: attack, defend, patrol…	Clear defenders, stand inside: the flag changes.

Capturing territory

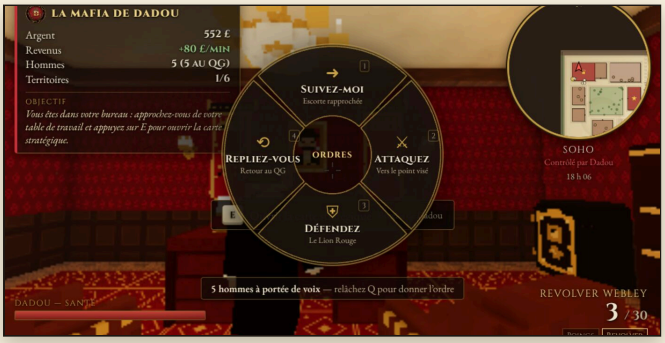
- **Buildings** are captured by having men inside with no enemy defenders: 12 s for a normal building, 20 s for a key building ★, 35 s for an HQ (times for one unit, faster with more men). Some neutral buildings without guards can simply be bought.
- **Districts** belong to whoever owns *all* their key buildings ★. Each district gives +£20/min and a Gazette headline.
- **The enemy HQ** is locked until you control **at least 3 districts**; the game says so clearly when you try. Capturing it wins the match.
- **Time limit** (optional): most districts wins, then most buildings, then most money.



Dadou's office. The prompt at the desk reads « Ouvrir la carte stratégique — Bureau de Dadou ». HUD: money, income, men, territories, objective, circular minimap.



The strategic map (« Bureau d'Even — Carte stratégique »): parchment-style city map, district ownership, ★ key buildings, tabs Ordres / Recrutement / Lieutenants / Améliorations / Armurerie.



Quick order wheel (hold Q near your men): Suivez-moi, Attaquez, Défendez, Repliez-vous. Works in the street, without the desk.



Lieutenants tab: each lieutenant has a squad, a live mission status (« ASSAUT EN COURS — LE CHAT NOIR ») and buttons to re-task him.

Lieutenants and orders

Up to 6 lieutenants, each leading a squad on one order: attack or defend a district or building, patrol, follow the boss, reinforce, retreat, hold. They report progress through notifications; a fallen lieutenant is out of action for 45 s. The **Télégraphe** upgrade opens the map anywhere (M).

CHAPTER 5

Systems and numbers

All values live in `src/shared/constants.ts` and `src/shared/characters.ts`. Reuse them as a starting point for balancing.

Economy

Starting money / men	£500 / 5
Recruit 1 · 5 · 10 men	£60 · £280 · £520
Max gangsters	120
Lieutenants 2 → 6	£250 · 400 · 600 · 850 · 1100
Building income	£15–35 /min each
District bonus	+£20 /min
Income paid every	5 s
Boss respawn	8 s, −10 % cash (max £150)

Health

Boss / lieutenant / gangster	150 / 130 / 70
Thug / police / HQ guard	60 / 90 / 110

Weapons

Name (in game)	Dmg	Mag	Range
Revolver Webley	26	6	60 m
Fusil de chasse (7 pellets)	13×7	2	25 m
Carabine Martini-Henry	55	5	110 m
Couteau	32	–	melee
Matraque	24	–	melee
Poings	12	–	melee

Right click aims (much more precise). Shotgun £220, rifle £320, ammo £30 at the HQ armoury.

Upgrades (« Améliorations »)

Upgrade	Effect	Price
Revolvers pour tous	Every gangster gets a Webley revolver	£350
Fusils de chasse	One gangster in three carries a shotgun (needs revolvers)	£600
Carabines Martini-Henry	One in four carries a precision rifle (needs revolvers)	£900
Gilets matelassés	+35 % health for all men	£500
Entraînement au tir	+20 % accuracy	£550
Gardes du QG	Four elite guards permanently at HQ	£400
Bureau de prestige	Luxury furniture and trophies appear in the office; +10 % income	£450
Télégraphe	Open the strategic map anywhere (M)	£500
Armurerie	Buy weapons and ammo at HQ	£300
Façade prestigieuse	Flags and lanterns in your colours on the HQ; +£5/min per district	£600

A living city

- **Police**: fighting raises a wanted level (0–5). Bobbies come for you; it decays when you stay out of sight. Scotland Yard is in Westminster.
- **Passers-by** walk the pavements and flee from gunshots. **Horse-drawn cabs** drive the streets and stop for pedestrians.
- **Newspaper**: *« La Gazette de Londres »* publishes headlines about captures and events.
- **Random events**, marked on map and minimap: *whisky contraband* (first boss there wins £250–450), *police raid* in a district, *pea-souper* yellow fog over London (perfect for surprise attacks), *informant* (enemy positions visible for 75 s).

The game in action



Street life: the boss walks among passers-by in period clothes, with shop fronts, signs and lamps.



« La Gazette de Londres » unfolds on screen: « GUERRE DES GANGS : DADOU ET EVEN SE DISPUTENT LONDRES ! »



Dadou's men in front of Le Lion Rouge at night. Gangsters wear their boss's colours (red bands, red scarves).



Death screen: « VOUS AVEZ ÉTÉ ABATTU » — the doctors patch you up at HQ, respawn in a few seconds.



First-person view with the Webley revolver. Voxel hands and weapons were modelled with care (sleeve in the boss's colour).



First person with the shotgun inside the office. Ammo counter bottom right, health bottom left.

CHAPTER 6

The look, the sound, the words

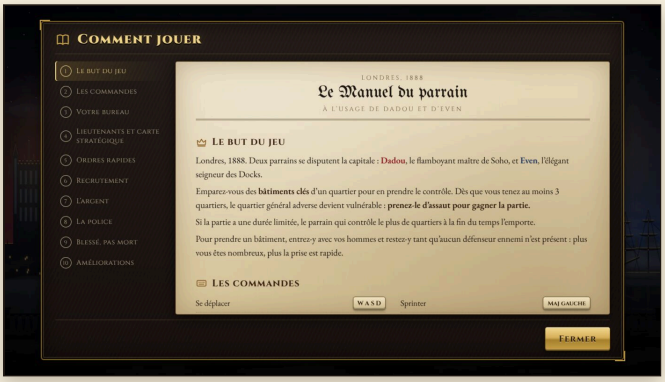
Art direction in one sentence

"A Victorian playbill rendered in voxels": blocky 3D world and characters, but presented through brass, parchment, crimson and navy, serif capitals and newspaper typography. The UI never looks like a debug overlay.

Palette (from `src/client/ui/theme.css`)

Dadou crimson	Even navy	Brass	Parchment	Night	Text
#9e1b22	#1d3461	#c9a24a	#e8dbbb	#0d0a09	#efe4cc

Fonts (bundled with npm `@fontsource`, no internet needed): CINZEL for titles and buttons, **CINZEL DECORATIVE** for the logo and big moments, EB Garamond for body text. The Gazette uses a newspaper layout with a large serif masthead.



« Comment jouer » — written as « Le Manuel du parrain », on parchment, with a table of contents.



« Commandes »: every action is rebindable, two keys per action, conflicts detected, reset button.

Default controls

ZQSD / WASD (by layout)	Move · Shift sprint · Space jump · C crouch
Left / right click	Shoot or hit / aim
1 2 3 4 · R	Fists, revolver, long gun, melee · reload
E	Interact (doors, desk, bar, armoury)
Q (hold)	Quick order wheel
M · Tab · V · Esc	Map · scores · 1st/3rd person · pause

Sound

All audio is **synthesised in the browser** with the Web Audio API (`src/client/audio/`): gunshots and footsteps with different reverb indoors and in the street, doors, wind between chimneys, distant traffic, room tone and a ticking mantel clock indoors, church bells, horse trot, UI clicks, and procedural period music. No audio files to license. Volumes per channel in the settings.

Writing style. The French voice is slightly theatrical and period-flavoured but always clear: *« Le QG d'Even est imprenable : contrôlez au moins 3 quartiers (vous en avez 1). »*, *« Les Docks passent sous la coupe de Dadou »*, *« Un épais brouillard jaune — un vrai "pea-souper" — tombe sur Londres. Idéal pour une attaque surprise… »*. Money is written the French way: **1 250 £**. Tutorials give one hint at a time, at the moment it is useful, never a wall of text.

CHAPTER 7

Under the hood

Stack: TypeScript (strict) everywhere · **Three.js** r180 for rendering · **Vite** 7 for the client build · **Node.js** 22 + **Socket.IO** 4.8 for the server · Playwright for browser tests. About **35 000 lines** of TypeScript, no external art or audio assets: everything (city, buildings, furniture, characters, weapons, sounds, music, logo) is generated by code.

Browser (client)

Menus and HUD in HTML/CSS · Three.js renderer with custom voxel shader, fog, day/night, bloom · City generated in a Web Worker from the shared plan (deterministic, identical on both machines) · Local player movement and collisions · Interpolation of other entities · Local passers-by and cabs (decorative).

⇄ Socket.IO 20 Hz binary snapshots + JSON events

Node server (authoritative)

Rooms with 4-letter codes · lobby and godfather picks · the whole simulation: AI of gangsters, thugs, police, lieutenants, navigation grid, combat resolution, captures, economy, events, victory · Sends each player only what changed (16 bytes per entity) · Reconnection by session token.

Code map

`src/shared/`	Code used by both sides: constants and rules, protocol and snapshot encoding, French grammar helpers, voxel storage and materials, navigation, **city plan and generator** (`city/plan.ts` , `city/gen/*`).
`src/server/`	`main.ts` (HTTP + Socket.IO, serves the client, embedded files in the .exe), `room.ts` (lobby, rematch), `game/Game.ts` (simulation, 1 600 lines), `game/npc.ts` , `game/squads.ts` .
`src/client/game/`	`GameClient.ts` (match loop), player controller, weapons and first-person view models, HUD, minimap, strategic map, order wheel, tutorial, doors, signs, civilians, carriages, effects.
`src/client/render/` · `world/`	Greedy voxel mesher with baked light, shader chunks, atmosphere (sky, sun, moon, fog), bloom post-processing, world loader and worker.
`src/client/models/` · `characters/`	Voxel props (furniture, street, venues, industry, monuments) and characters (bosses, gangsters, police, civilians) built in code, with procedural animation.
`src/client/ui/` · `audio/` · `input/`	Screens (menu, lobby, settings, controls, help, victory), theme CSS, portraits · procedural audio engine · rebindable input.
`scripts/build-exe.mjs`	Builds `MafiaWars.exe` : client + server bundled into one Windows executable with Node's "single executable application" feature.
`tests/`	`run-all.ts` (47 headless checks of rules, French grammar, protocol), `e2e.mjs` (two real browsers play a match), `bot.mjs` (a scripted opponent), `rematch.mjs` (network scenario).

Distribution

Players get `release/MafiaWars-Windows.zip` . Only the host double-clicks `MafiaWars.exe` : a console window runs the server (keep it open), the browser opens on the game, and a free Cloudflare quick tunnel (`cloudflared.exe` , shipped in the zip) makes the invite link a public `https://….trycloudflare.com` address that works from anywhere. The friend just opens the link. **Lesson from real use:** both players first launched the .exe and typed the code into their own copy, which cannot work (a game exists only on the host's server); the join box now explains this and follows pasted links. Developers use `npm run dev` ; `npm run build:exe` rebuilds the executable.

> **Why these choices mattered.** A server-authoritative simulation made cheating and desync a non-issue and let NPC armies (200+ men) fight consistently on both screens. Generating the city deterministically on each client kept network traffic tiny. Building every asset in code meant no licensing problems and easy tweaks. Keep these ideas unless the sequel has a good reason to change them.

CHAPTER 8

Lessons learned and honest limitations

Bugs we hit (avoid them the second time)

Problem	Cause and fix
Server crash mid-match	A dead lieutenant's entity was removed while his squad still pointed to it. Fix: never delete leaders of live squads; defensive checks; every room tick wrapped in try/catch so one error cannot kill the server.
Player stuck or crouched at spawn	Furniture placed on spawn points. Fix: keep spawn areas clear, an "unstick" routine, reset crouch on teleport.
Mouse captured inside menus	Pointer lock must be released whenever any panel opens and re-acquired only on click in the world.
Strategic map buttons dead	The panel was re-rendered every update, detaching click handlers. Fix: update values in place, rebuild only on structure change.
Washed-out faction colours, overly strong bloom, windows glowing from inside	Double gamma correction and post-processing tuning. Check colours against the CSS palette in a screenshot.
Bad French in generated sentences	"de Le Chat Noir", "tenu par à vendre". Fix: grammar helpers (`leNom` , `deNom` , `aNom`) and tests for every template.
Rematch showed the old match	Client state not fully reset. Fix: dispose and recreate the game client; tested by `tests/rematch.mjs` .

How it was tested

The build machine had no graphics card (software rendering, about 1 frame per second), so testing used: headless rule checks, a scripted bot opponent over Socket.IO, low-graphics mode for Chromium, debug teleports, and screenshots inspected one by one. A load test of 230 fighting gangsters ran at 2–4 ms per server tick. **Real-hardware frame rates were never measured**, and the Windows .exe was verified through an identical Linux build, not on Windows itself.

Known limitations of the first game

- Exactly two human players. No AI opponent, no solo mode.
- Passers-by and cabs are simulated separately by each browser (the two players do not see the same crowd). Gangsters, police and bosses are synchronised.
- Needs a real graphics card; software rendering is very slow. Low/medium quality and render scale help.
- The city is generated at load time on each client (a few seconds).
- The .exe is unsigned (Windows SmartScreen warns once) and about 87 MB once unzipped. Internet play relies on Cloudflare's free quick tunnel (no uptime guarantee); without it, only same-network play works.
- One city, one map layout; no persistent progression between matches.

> **Advice for the sequel's builder.** Plan the architecture first, keep the server authoritative, build a test bot early, write French strings through grammar helpers from day one, take screenshots and actually look at them, and keep a short, true "what works / what doesn't" list for the user at every step.

Ideas for the sequel, and a starter prompt

These are suggestions, not decisions. Present them to the user and let them choose.

- **New era or city**: 1920s Chicago with Prohibition, Belle Époque Paris, or London ten years later. The bosses age and change costume but stay recognisable.
- **Story continuity**: open on a Gazette front page recalling who won the first war.
- **Solo and co-op**: an AI godfather so each friend can practise alone, or both against a third family.
- **Vehicles**: drivable horse cabs, then cars in a later era.
- **Deeper businesses**: rackets, smuggling routes, bribes to the police, rival lieutenants with traits.
- **Persistent campaign**: territory carried across several evenings of play.
- **Synchronised crowds**, bigger map, a dedicated online server so nobody has to host.
- **Keep**: the desk, the Gazette, the wheel, the Revanche button, the French voice.

Starter prompt (give this to the new Claude together with this PDF)

```
I am attaching the "series bible" of a game you (another Claude) built for me:
MAFIA WARS : Dadou vs Even, a two-player online voxel mafia game set in
Victorian London (1888). Read the whole document before doing anything.

I want a sequel: MAFIA WARS 2 : Dadou vs Even. Keep the spirit of the first
game, especially the non-negotiables in chapter 0:
- the two bosses are named exactly "Dadou" and "Even" (never David/Evan);
  their gangs are "La Mafia de Dadou" and "La Mafia d'Even";
- every player-facing text in natural, correct French;
- two human players online with a lobby, exclusive boss choice, room code,
  ready buttons, reconnection, and a "Revanche" button at the end;
- you play the boss in person (1st/3rd person, key V) AND command your
  mafia from a desk in your HQ ("Bureau de Dadou" / "Bureau d'Even");
- a warm, polished voxel look with enterable furnished buildings;
- Dadou = crimson/black and flamboyant, Even = navy/silver and elegant.

For the sequel I would like: [setting / era], [new features], [anything to
remove or change]. Before coding, propose a short plan: setting, core loop,
what stays from the first game, what is new, and the tech architecture.
Wait for my answer. Then build it, test it for real, and tell me honestly
what works and what does not.
```

The original source code is in the GitHub repository `dadou2329/mafia-wars` (branch `claude/quirky-shannon-tqacuu`). If the new Claude has access to it, it should read `README.md` and `src/shared/` first and can reuse the engine instead of starting from zero.